

Interview Guide

Goal: test our assumptions about the problem, current coping behavior, AI awareness, reaction to the concept, and willingness to pay - before building further.

Final Questions List:

Hi, we are Hopkins Engineering students trying to build a tool helping people on a daily basis.

Would you be open to a 10–15 minute interview with us? We'd love to learn more about your experiences to better understand your needs and challenges.

1. During your daily routine, have you face any circumstances that need to get help with some technologies? How often?
2. a. If you face a problem, do you ask others or prefer to do on your own? If you work on your own, what do you typically do(eg.)?
b. When you're stuck using an appliance (such as an air fryer, oven, robot vacuum, TV, or any other household device) what do you usually do first?
 - Check the printed manual
 - Search online (Google, YouTube, etc.)
 - Ask a family member or friend
 - Contact customer support or the manufacturer
 - Other (please specify)
3. How long did it take to get help?(confirming our product helps & efficiency) Of the methods listed above, which do you find most effective and least effective? Why?
4. Which type of device have you had the most trouble using in the past?
5. Have you used a voice assistant (Siri, Alexa, Google)? Have you tried ChatGPT or Gemini?
6. To what extent do you think an easy guided AI is trustworthy enough to help you going though the whole process? If yes, any ideal features? No, why and what to improve?
7. If an app could explain a confusing button just from a photo and give step-by-step instructions, would that seem useful? Why or why not?
8. Would you prefer text, voice, image, video guidance, or something else - and why?
9. Would it be useful to have a feature that lets you know if you've completed a step correctly? If so, what would be the easiest way for you to receive that feedback ? -(such as voice guidance, pictures, visual prompts, or another option?)
10. Would you pay for this – why not? (one-time, subscription, or only if free)
11. What would make an app like this simple enough that you'd actually want to use it? How often would you use this tool?
12. Anything else about using a new appliance that frustrates you?